



HIGH TAX, LOW DEFICIT

Helped by steady collections and measures to reduce tax evasion, India is expected to surpass its tax collection goal of ₹19.34 lakh crore by more than ₹2 lakh crore in the current fiscal, according to two officials with knowledge of the matter. Strong revenue receipts are giving PM Narendra Modi's government leeway to contain the budget deficit within 6.4 per cent of GDP amid a ballooning subsidy bill, said the officials.

—PRINCE TYAGI

LANDMARK RULING

In a ruling that could have repercussions for companies that fail to clear employees' dues after shutting operations, the NCLAT has held that the resolution plan of the Jalan-Kalrock Consortium for Jet Airways went against the Employees Provident Fund Act, 1952. The two-member NCLAT bench observed that the plan failed to provide for payment of provident fund and gratuity to the airline staff. Several employees termed the judgment as the best Diwali gift since the airline folded up in April 2019.

—MANISH PANT

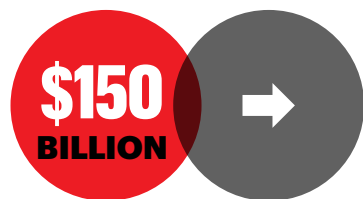
PHOTO BY RACHIT GOSWAMI



REALITY CHECK

Some of the popular listings of 2021 have plunged over 50 per cent from their respective all-time highs so far. This includes Policybazaar operator PB Fintech, Paytm's parent entity One97 Communications, food delivery firm Zomato and FSN E-Commerce Ventures Ltd, which runs online fashion retailer Nykaa. Market watchers believe their IPOs' sky-high valuations have played spoilsport. "Investors with a high risk appetite can consider these shares," says Kranthi Bathini, Equity Strategist at WealthMills Securities.

—RAHUL OBEROI



PLANNED INVESTMENT BY GAUTAM ADANI'S GROUP IN BUSINESSES LIKE GREEN ENERGY, DATA CENTRES, AIRPORTS, HEALTHCARE AS IT CHASES THE DREAM TO JOIN AN ELITE GLOBAL CLUB OF COMPANIES WITH VALUATIONS OF \$1 TRILLION

Shocks from Bharat

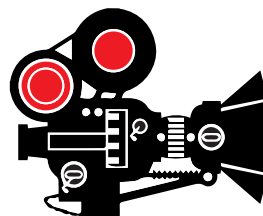
ONCE THE GROWTH driver for the country's consumer goods majors, the rural market has turned into their Achilles heel since the Covid-19 pandemic. From double-digit growth in pre-Covid-19 years, volume offtake in the hinterlands have turned negative in recent quarters. Volume sales of FMCG products in rural India have shrunk by 9 per cent—dragging the overall market by 6 per cent—between October 2021 and September 2022, as per Nielsen data. The faltering growth of consumer goods companies in India's small towns and villages points to the impact of steep inflation on rural household budgets.

—ARNAB DUTTA

PHOTO BY MANEESH AGNIHOTRI



IT'S SHOWTIME. AGAIN



Following a string of flops in Bollywood, multiplex operators are now banking on reruns of old Hindi films to get audiences back to the theatres. On the occasion of Shah Rukh Khan's birthday on November 2, PVR, INOX Movies and Cinépolis ran the superstar's blockbuster *Dilwale Dulhania Le Jayenge* on their screens. Ditto Amitabh Bachchan's 80th birthday, when the multiplexes brought back the megastar's cult films like *Deewar*, *Don*, *Namak Halal*, and *Amar Akbar Anthony*, and still saw full houses almost half a century after their release.

—PRERNA LIDHOO